C1 Vocabulary

Academic vocabulary for essays

High-value words from academic English that lift the register of your writing.

These words appear frequently in academic texts across all subjects. Swap them in for simpler words to make your essays more precise.

substantial adj.

large in amount or importance

There is substantial evidence for this claim.

undermine verb

to weaken gradually

Constant criticism can undermine confidence.

inherent adj.

existing as a natural, permanent part

Every investment carries inherent risk.

facilitate verb

to make a process easier

Technology can facilitate learning.

discrepancy noun

a difference between things that should match

There was a discrepancy between the two reports.

advocate verb

to publicly support an idea

Many experts advocate earlier intervention.

plausible adj.

seeming reasonable or likely

This is a plausible explanation.

mitigate verb

to make something less harmful

Measures were taken to mitigate the impact.

notion noun

an idea or belief

The notion of free will is debated.

comprehensive adj.

including everything necessary

The report gives a comprehensive overview.

subsequently adv.

after that; later

The data was subsequently analysed.

constrain verb

to limit or restrict

Our research was constrained by funding.

Practice

1. Replace the simple word: The new road will *make easier* trade between the towns.
2. Replace the simple word: Several studies *support* a four-day week.
3. Replace the simple word: The results *weaken* the original theory.

▼ Show answers

1. facilitate
2. advocate

3. undermine